1629 9/4

FJ 10310/86 9/

British Embassy,
Tokyo

1st July, 1952

CONFIDENTIAL

1030/115/52

FJ10310/85

Dear Department,

In our letter 1030/112/52 of the 23rd June about Japan's relations with Nationalist China we said that a further "authoritative" statement contradicting that given in that letter might well appear. It has appeared even sooner than we expected, and it has come from no less a person than Mr. Yoshida himself.

2. Speaking at the Foreign Affairs Committee of the House of Councillors on the 27th June Mr. Yoshida stated that his Government still wanted to enter into friendly relations with the whole of China, and when asked by a Rightwing Socialist whether it could be understood that the Government did not recognise the Nationalist regime as sovereign over the whole of the mainland, Mr. Yoshida assented.

3. The Government's position is thus back to orthodoxy after the deviation of the Shimoda-Wajima statement described in paragraph 3 of our letter under reference, but what the next move will be is impossible to say. Mr. Wajima, who is the Chief of the Asian Affairs Bureau, tells us privately that the situation is confused beyond his comprehension and that if he is again summoned before the Diet to explain the Government's position on China he proposes to say that he does not know!

We are sending copies of this letter to the Chanceries at Washington and Peking and to the Consulate at Tamsui.

Yours ever,

CHANCERY

Japan & Pacific Department,
Foreign Office,
LONDON, S.W.1.

Reference:
FO 371/99405
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION